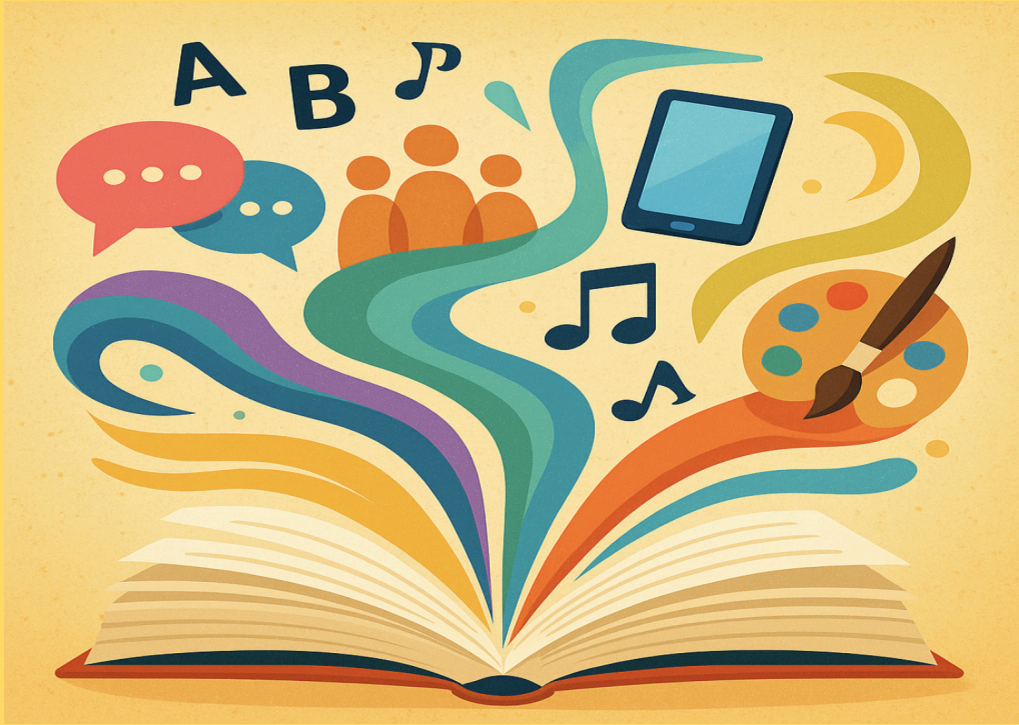


Class 2: Defining Literacies

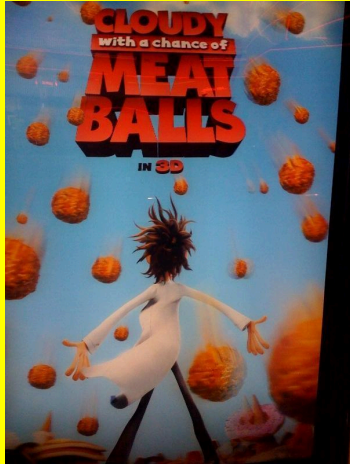


Wellness check in: “This Is Me: Today’s Edition”

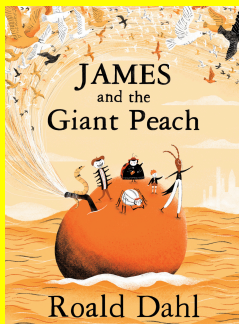
“Choose a book or magazine cover, landing page, etc (real or imagined) that reflects how you’re feeling right now—emotionally, mentally, or physically. You can share just the title, describe the vibe or design, or explain why it captures your current mood or mindset.”

Examples:

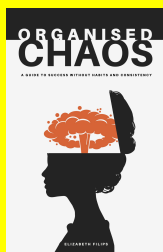
Cloudy With a Chance of Meatballs – “Things feel a little chaotic but kind of funny.”



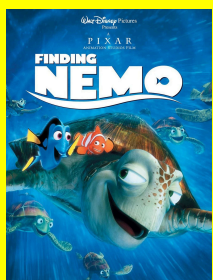
My Little Pony because I am surrounded by my friends :) I reached out to a friend in need and we shared a hug as a result of me opening up communication. I also reached out to an old friend whose birthday is today, and caught up with him, which left me feeling joyful and excited for the future.



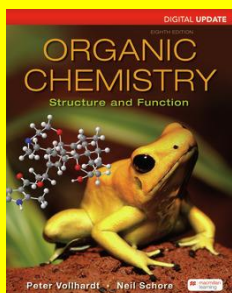
James and the Giant Peach because I feel like I'm on an adventure.



Organized Chaos: Everything feels a little hectic at the moment with juggling schoolwork, personal responsibilities, and work but somehow I'm still organized.



Finding Nemo—I feel like I am starting to find the groove in my life and everything is falling into place (even though the future is a bit shaky and feels like a long journey ahead of me). Starting a new chapter, I hope to form new connections and persevere :))



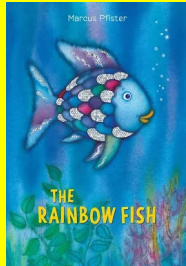
This is a bit silly but I'm teaching "organic chemistry" to my students right now and I feel a lot like how I did before I started my college organic chemistry classes— no idea what is going on and I'm already confused. This frog is also kind of relatable



I've never actually seen this movie but I feel like the title sums up how I'm feeling—pretty busy and all over the place. I just moved and along with unpacking I've been working full time and just starting classes again after a year off of school.



I am very exhausted this week, a lot of new things are coming. I am also in charge of a butterfly exhibit and I've seen a lot of butterflies emerge from their chrysalids. The news are also very demotivating.



Rainbow Fish because I had a lot of Goldfish before class and am feeling cheerful.

Revisit Classroom Guidelines (15 min.)

Classroom Guidelines

In break out rooms Synthesize your questions to 1-2MAX sentences

We will collectively agree on them after

1. Remember the human.- Remember that everyone has been through their own challenges. Treat your classmates' critiques as good faith attempts to engage with you. Be culturally competent. Engage in conscious cultural relativism. Assume good intentions when interacting with others. Take time to consider how multifaceted we are. Consider sensitivities and remember that emotion or passion is not the same as weakness or irrationality.

Remember that everyone has been through their own challenges, and that emotion/passion is not the same as weakness/irrationality. Be considerate of others and understand that they are trying

to engage with you and your culture, so you should respectfully attempt to do the same.

2. Adhere to the same standards of behavior online that you follow in real life.- Engage online respectfully. Do not use the online realm as a shelter for disrespectful behavior. Treat others with the kindness you would treat your friends. Remember the virtual world still reflects the real one. Act civilly online. Engage constructively in discussions.

3. Know where you are in cyberspace.- Familiarize yourself with the technology being utilized. Hop onto Zoom a little earlier to ensure that you can make it into the classroom. Be aware of what you share in the cyberspace. Be conscientious of your own digital footprint. Be considerate about your use of AI and related technology. Be mindful of the digital tools you use.

Use technology meaningfully, ensuring that you are aware of the strengths and limitations of your digital resources.

4. Respect other people's time and bandwidth.- Communicate Challenges. Be fully engaged when someone else is contributing. Be considerate of other people's time to share their thoughts; don't be a discussion hog! Step up, step back. If you have not spoken yet, speak up, share your opinion, even if it is brief. If you are speaking a lot, step back, let someone else take the stage. Use the same receptive social skills as you would in person. Be concise when possible. If you notice that someone else wants to speak, step back

5. Make yourself look good online- ensure your face is in full frame and that you do not have any distracting backgrounds or visual effects enabled . - Be present to the fullest extent possible, as though you were in an in-person setting – that doesn't mean you have to look perfect at all times. Be prepared to be fully present. Be comfortable in what you are wearing. Show yourself as if you were in an in-person class. Practice active listening when appropriate.

6. Share expert knowledge. Make contributions with strong foundations. Participate with critical thinking. Know that it's okay if you are unfamiliar with a topic; that's the point of learning. Acknowledge that intelligence is relative. Recognize our shared goal of

learning and working toward shared conclusions when possible.

7. Help keep flame wars under control. Agree to disagree when necessary, and advocate for open and respectful communication. Communicate with others with an open mind and do not be offended if someone has a different viewpoint than you. Practice listening deeply. Recognize certain scenarios that should not be engaged with. Accept that disagreements and discomfort will occur, but remember that we are all first and foremost in community together as learners.

Accept that disagreements and discomfort will occur, and advocate for open and respectful communication. Experiencing discomfort and conflict helps us to grow as learners.

8. Respect other people's privacy. Do not share personal information that others confided in during the class. Take the lesson away from the moment, not the story. Engage conscientiously. Think about how you value your own privacy and apply that lens towards other people online. Engage with others at their level, being open to what they are willing to offer while maintaining boundaries.

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9. Don't abuse your power. – Be aware of how much space you take up in a room and work towards lifting others up rather than shutting them down. Be cognizant of the power you carry and how you can use that power for good. Be conscious of your privileges and how they can affect others. Recognize that your experiences will be different from everyone else's. Everyone carries some level of power and privilege, be conscious of how you wield it. Respect everyone and remember we are all diversely oppressed by broader power dynamics in some way. Listen first, especially when in a position of leadership.

10. Be forgiving of other people's mistakes. We are all here to learn, and brave spaces are there to challenge our viewpoints, and those of others. Making mistakes is a part of being human; be aware of these mistakes and learn from them. Be gentle with yourself

and others; these are opportunities for growth. Do not blame just the person, try to step in their shoes or look at the bigger picture. Remember that we bring our whole selves into the classroom, and education is a holistic, active process.

Approach the mistakes of yours and your peers with empathy and openness as to be human is to make mistakes. Recognize in these moments opportunities for growth, deeper and new found understandings of ourselves, our community and the topics we are tackling

Class 2 Objectives:

- o **Collectively Set Norms - revisit classroom guidelines**
- o **Expand Multiliteracies Awareness:** We will broaden our understanding of literacy to include diverse, multimodal forms of expression, such as visual, digital, and performative literacies, through activities like pantomime. This will help us recognize the various ways literacy can manifest beyond traditional text-based forms.
- o **Reflect on Literacy as a Tool for Empowerment:** Drawing on the theories of multiliteracies and Ghoddy Muhammad's notion of literacy as a tool for liberation and power, we will reflect on and broaden our personal definitions of literacy. This reflection will include considering the potential of literacy to foster liberation, empowerment, and social change within their communities.

Activating our Understanding (8 min)



1. **Expressive Interpretation:** Historically, pantomime, originating from ancient Greek and Roman theater. It was a powerful way to communicate without words. However, it has also been misused in ways that perpetuate harmful stereotypes.
2. **To reclaim this tradition,** in the **breakout rooms** spend 1-2 minutes considering something that brings you joy and **choose non-verbal method to communicate** it that honors your cultural identity, such as gestures, visual art, instrumental music, or any other form of silent expression. Take turns with your partner but **do not tell your speaking partner with words what you are trying to say.**
3. **Return to whole group for share out:** We will share in the mainroom how we interpreted our partners pantomime. We will discuss what you learned about your source of joy and reflect on the cultural and historical significance of the mode of expression you chose. Consider how non-verbal communication and its cultural variations inform our understanding of connection and expression in our communities today.

Activity 2: Extending the Discussion Board Conversation: Core Questions About Literacy (15 min Breakout + 5-7 Main room)

This week's readings ask us to reconsider what counts as literacy, who gets to define it, and how we as educators can support students' full humanity and agency as readers. The following quotes and questions, courtesy of Group A discussants and some light curation, are designed to help us get to the heart of those ideas especially as we think about joy, criticality, identity, and power in literacy learning.

Directions : In your breakout groups select 2–3 of the following questions to focus your group conversation. Tell us which questions you focused on and take notes in the provided box below. Elect a spokesperson to speak for the group in the main room :

- 1. What counts as reading?**
In your eyes (and in your classroom), what qualifies as valid forms of reading: physical books, audiobooks, comics, video games, YouTube subtitles? What doesn't count, and why and who gets to decide?
students of color, and what practical steps can we take to prioritize them?
- 2. Can “snackable” or “situated” content be meaningful?**
How might we reframe students' consumption of digital content as a form of literacy and what does it take to help them engage with it more critically?
- 3. How do we reflect students back to themselves?**
Bishop talks about “lighting conditions” making a window a mirror. What kinds of choices can educators make (in texts, activities, or discussion) to make this transformation possible?
- 4. How do we elevate the student voice while holding onto facts?**
In classrooms where many students share targeted identities (e.g., Black and Latinx youth), how do we support both emotional truth and critical thinking?
How do we hold space for disagreement within the community?
- 5. Souto-Manning & Yoon (2018): “Young children are exposed to language in various contexts before entering school – homes, communities, peers, and the environment. They start reading their environment and authoring themselves in the world.” How can we incorporate more of these books into the school curriculum?**
- 6. Mackery (2020): “Access to reading material is not a politically neutral issue. The publishing industry in English-speaking countries is still very white, both in terms of personnel and product. “We Need Diverse Books” is a campaign that aims to broaden the range and appeal of what is made available to young people; one point that seems very clear is that readers cannot acquire what does not exist.” They need the books as windows onto reality, not just on imaginary worlds” (Bishop, R. pp. 1)How we can, as teachers, balance meeting required academic standards while also incorporating everything we know about literacy learning.**
- 7. A question to ponder throughout the semester but ... how could we answer this knowing what we know right now: How can the CHRL framework provide more**

meaningful and lasting change in the classroom compared to frameworks already out there, like culturally responsive pedagogy?

8. Souto-Manning & Yoon (2018) establishes three ways educators can transform unjust sociocultural realities: embodied literacy, racial literacy, and critical literacy (76). They give really practical examples of each of these literacies in action but do not discuss their intersectionality. Is there a way to incorporate all three of these literacies at the same time, or if educators should prioritize a specific literacy depending on student demographics and/or daily course content?

Group 1 Names
Question

Group 2 Names:
Question

Group 3 Names
Question

10 min. Break

[Theory: Slide Deck](#) (20 min)

Names :	At first, we thought....	Now we think....

Looking Ahead:

Readings Class 3: Towards the Pursuit of Joy

Unearthing Joy: A Guide to Culturally and Historically Responsive Curriculum Chapter 2

Activating Joy Through Culturally and

Historically Responsive Read-Alouds

Choose one :

Unfolding joy in young children's literacy practices in a Finnish early years classroom

Activating Joy and Hope in Critical Literacies Instruction: Responding Pedagogically to

Youth Skepticism in a YPAR Project

Asynchronous work: Activity 3 Part 1: Building on the Basics															
Building our collective capacities and reflecting on our readings, what is missing from the new basics?															
How can we expand new basics to incorporate the readings from this module?															
Include 1-2 Culturally Historically Responsive Foundations that should be considered basics.															
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Part 2: New Learners & New Teachers																			
Building our collective capacities and reflecting on our readings, what is missing from the new teachers' definitions? How can we expand how we define “New Teachers” to incorporate the readings from this module. Include 1-2 Culturally Historically Responsive teaching approaches that should be part of a “New Teachers” practice.																			
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[illegible]